

income is good. A mining supervisor makes an average of \$64,480 a year managing laborers and coordinating activities, both above ground in quarries and below ground in mines.

10. **Construction inspector.** *Top 50 rank: #48.* At \$62,400 a year, construction inspectors make a nice living. These are the guys who inspect buildings to make sure they're safe, structurally sound and up to code, whether it's a 1950s apartment building or a brand new suspension bridge. Most inspectors are hired by the government, which can mean a nice benefit package and cushy pension. If you're a maverick type, you can choose to be self-employed, working with construction and architectural firms in more of a consulting role.